Experiment – 11

Portal User

Creating a Portal and Adding Portal Users in Zoho Creator

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Application Name: Purchase Request / Procurement Application

Objective

To set up a portal for a Zoho Creator application, add external users, and assign portal permissions so that requesters and department heads can access the application according to their roles.

Introduction

A portal in Zoho Creator provides an online access point for external users such as customers, vendors, and business partners. Portal users sign in through a dedicated page and receive permissions that determine which forms, reports, pages, and records they can access. Using separate permission profiles allows one application to serve different external user groups while limiting access to the information relevant to each group.

Portal Components

Component	Description	Use in this Experiment
Portal	Online gateway for people outside the organization	Portal for the College application, displayed as Public
Sign-in page	Page where portal users enter their login details	Email Address field, Next button, Forgot Password and Sign Up links
Portal user	External person permitted to access the portal	ARJUNRAJ and Tony
Portal user permission	Profile controlling which application features a user can access	Requester Portal and HOD

Table 11.1: Main components of the Zoho Creator portal.

Portal User Permissions

The College application has four portal user permission profiles available under Settings. The profiles provide different levels of access according to the responsibilities of the user.

Permission	Description
Customer	Profile with add and view permissions
HOD	Finance HOD Portal User; follows the Finance user permission setup
Requester Portal	Requester Portal User; follows the Requester user permission setup
Finance Portal	Allows Finance users to view procurement data

Table 11.2: Portal user permission profiles available in the application.

Portal Users Added

Name	Email Address	Username	Permission
ARJUNRAJ	arjunrajm11@gmail.com	arjunraj	Requester Portal
Tony	tony441007@gmail.com	portal_tony	HOD

Table 11.3: Users added to the portal and their assigned permissions.

Screenshot-Based Lab Record

The screenshots below show the portal setup and user permission configuration in Zoho Creator.

Screenshot 1 – Creating the Portal

The Portal section under Deploy initially shows that no portal has been created. The Create New option begins the setup process.

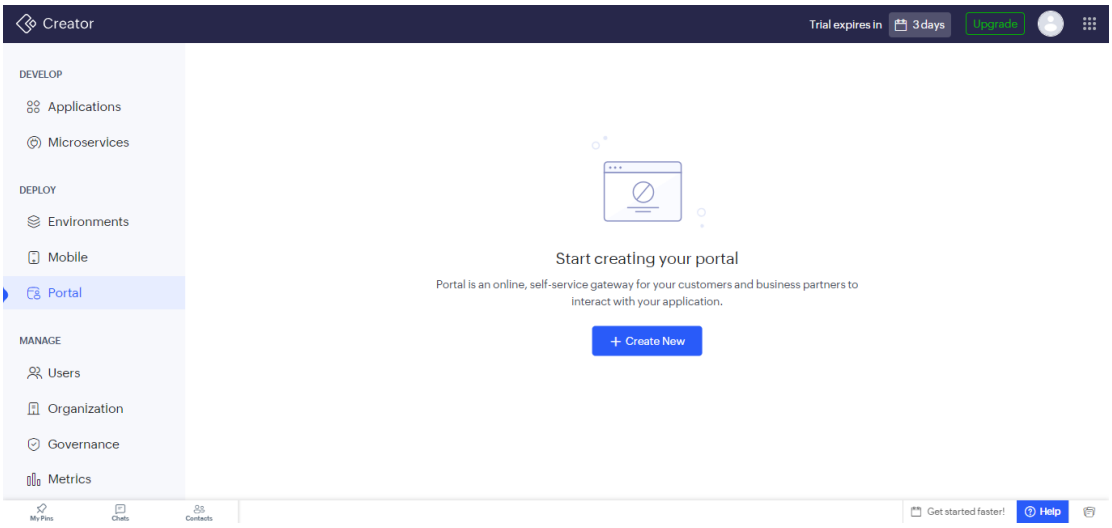


Figure 1: Portal section before a portal is created.

Screenshot 2 – Configuring the Portal

The Create Portal page provides templates and a Create From Scratch option. The Configure Portal dialog is used to select the application that the portal will be based on.

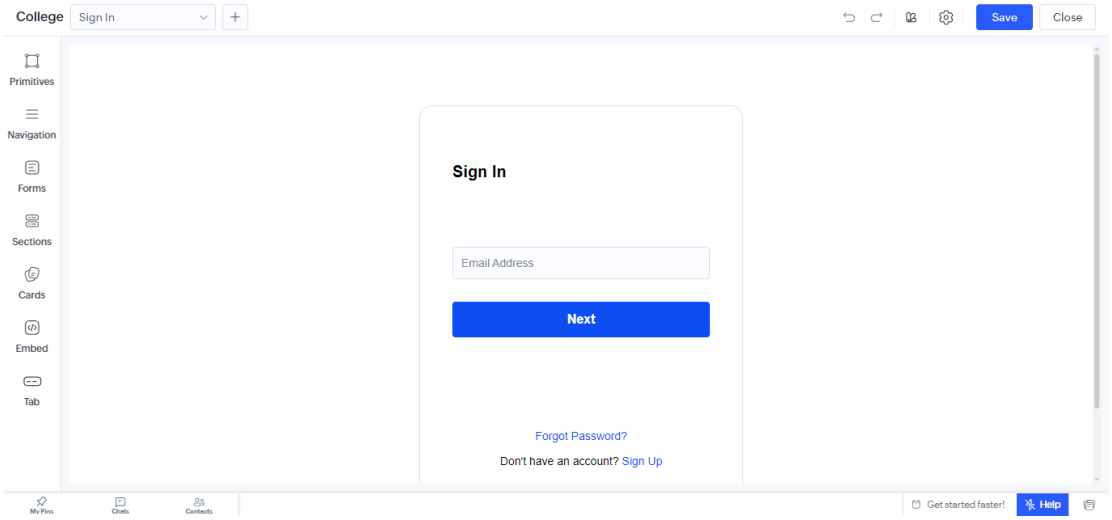


Figure 2: Configure Portal dialog for selecting the application.

Screenshot 3 – Portal Sign-in Page

The portal page builder displays the Sign In page with an Email Address field, Next button, Forgot Password link, and Sign Up link. Page elements can be adjusted through the builder panel.

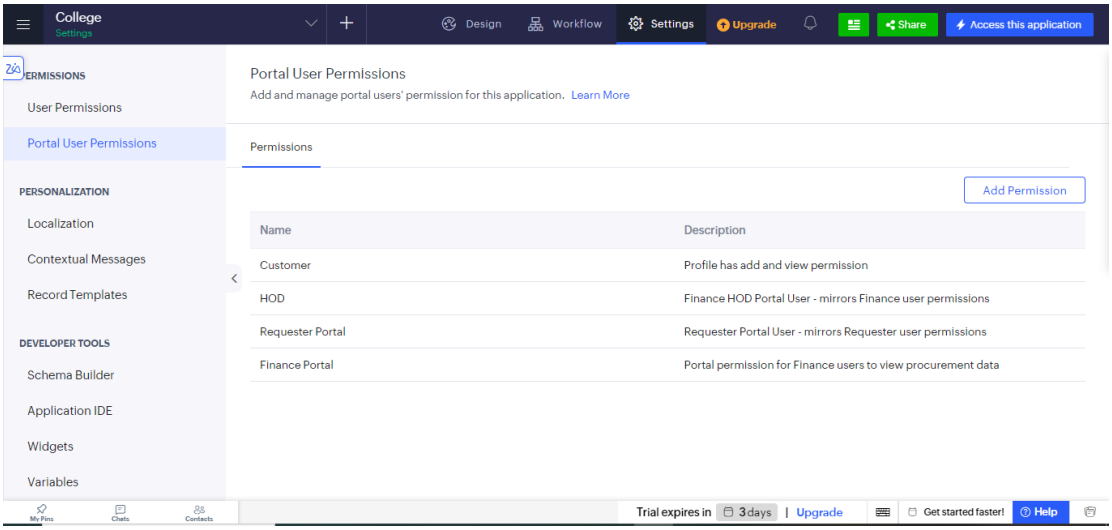


Figure 3: Sign In page in the portal page builder.

Screenshot 4 – Adding Portal Users

The Add Portal Users panel accepts a user's name and email address, allows notification email to be enabled, and provides a permission selector. ARJUNRAJ was assigned the Requester Portal permission.

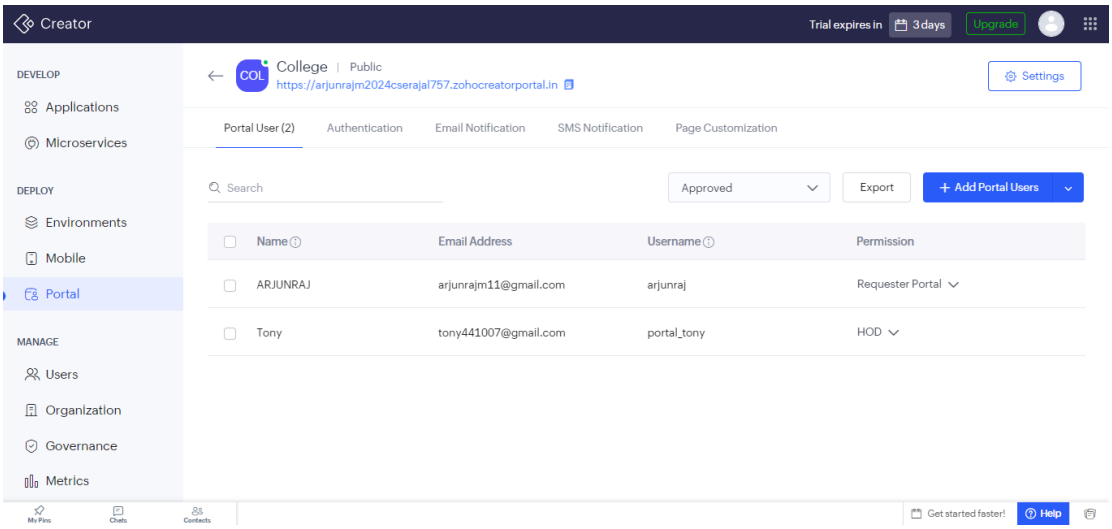


Figure 4: Add Portal Users panel with user details and permission.

Screenshot 5 – Portal User List

After users are added, the Portal User tab lists their names, email addresses, usernames, and assigned permissions. The reference shows ARJUNRAJ and Tony.

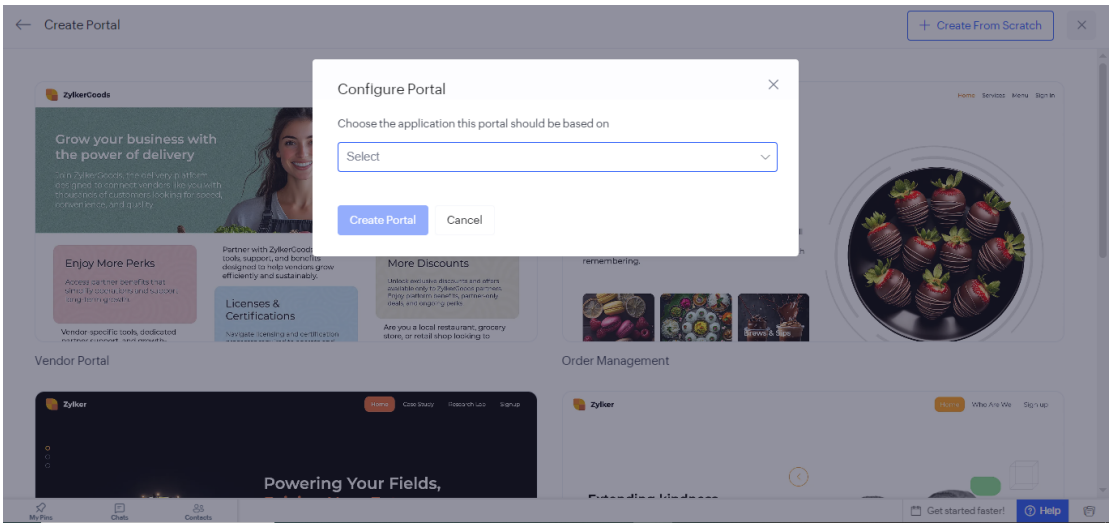


Figure 5: Portal User tab listing the two portal users.

Screenshot 6 – Portal User Permissions

Portal user permissions are managed from Settings. The page lists Customer, HOD, Requester Portal, and Finance Portal, and includes an option to add another permission.

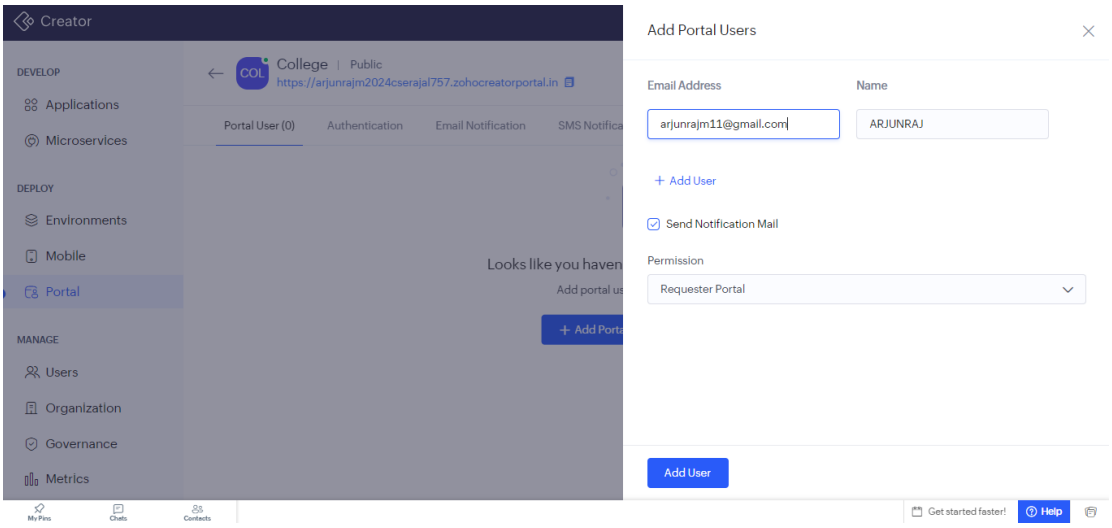


Figure 6: Portal User Permissions page.

Observation

The portal and its users were configured through the Zoho Creator interface without writing code. Users sign in using their email addresses, and the assigned permission determines the parts of the application they can access. The requester and HOD have different roles, so each receives access appropriate to their tasks. Portal users are external participants who use the portal, while regular users belong to the organization and use the application's internal access settings.

Result

A portal was configured for the College application, and two portal users were listed: ARJUNRAJ with the Requester Portal permission and Tony with the HOD permission. The Customer, HOD, Requester Portal, and Finance Portal profiles provide options for controlling portal access.